The Paper Trail for Mom's Care

Bills, receipts, contracts and policies: where each one is, who holds it, and which ones you still have to find.

The care bills are in a folder, the receipts are in an envelope in the kitchen, and the agreement Mom signed with her care provider is somewhere in your brother's car.

This page doesn't ask you to understand any of it. It asks where each paper is, what date is on it, and who has it.

WHAT TO COLLECT	WHERE IT IS	ITS DATE	WHO HAS IT
Bills from Mom's care provider, month by month			
The agreement or contract signed with the care provider			
Receipts and records of what has been paid for her care			
Statements for the accounts her care is paid from			
Bills and statements for her debts and regular expenses			
Receipts or estimates for home or personal expenses			
Her insurance policies, with the latest statement for each			
Any annuity contract, with its latest statement			
Her retirement account statements			
Paperwork for any burial or funeral arrangement			
Records of any gift, repayment, transfer, sale or account change already made			
Anything in writing about a financial product someone has suggested			

What hasn't turned up yet, and who will look for it

Anything above with an empty line. Put a name next to each.

FOR EXAMPLE Can't find the agreement Mom signed with her care provider. David will ask the business office for a copy.

How to use it

- Write the date printed on each paper. If it has no date, write “undated.”
- Don't rewrite or summarize a paper here. Just say where it is.
- As new bills, receipts and contracts arrive, add a line for each. Keep the receipt, and note the date, the amount, what it was for and who was paid.
- Bring this page and the papers to the conversation with your Medicaid planner.

What this page doesn't do

It doesn't explain what any bill, contract or policy means, or what it may mean for Medicaid. If you read something you don't understand, that's a question for whoever issued it or for your Medicaid planner. Nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You know where the paper trail is, who holds each piece and what hasn't turned up yet. The planning interview asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring to any conversation about paying for Mom's care. Keep this page beside you while you answer.

Get Your Free Planning Report ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

Keeping receipts, and noting the date, the amount, the reason and who was paid, follows the Consumer Financial Protection Bureau's guide for people who manage money for a family member. The rows come from the Medicaid Planning Roadmap's working list for this step.

1. Consumer Financial Protection Bureau, Managing Someone Else's Money: Help for agents under a power of attorney